BEST VERSION OF ME

GLOBAL COMMUNITY SPORTS

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This journal is designed to help you reflect on your strengths, values, and areas for growth. This journal, alongside the workshop, provides the tools and space to continue to build essential skills in emotional intelligence, leadership, and communication, as you work toward becoming the best version of yourself.

At Global Community Sports, we believe that becoming the best version of yourself involves embracing continuous growth. We focus on supporting individuals, teams, and groups, to explore how to develop self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, and relationship management—skills that will support your journey towards personal excellence.

It's important to note that we are not mental health professionals. The insights and strategies shared in our workshops and journals are drawn from a range of sources, including research, professional development, and lived experience.

We would love to hear about your journey and any feedback you may have.

www.globalcommunitysports.com

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Acknowledgement of Country

This journal was created on Kaurna land. We would like to acknowledge the Kaurna people as the traditional custodians of the Adelaide region, whose resilience and leadership have guided their connection to land, waters, and community for thousands of years. We honour their Elders past and present and recognise their enduring strength and resilience.

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Name:

School/organisation:

SELF-AWARENESS

Self-awareness is understanding your thoughts, feelings, and behaviours.

SELF-AWARENESS SKILLS RATING	1 (low)	2	3	4	5 (high)
Emotional Awareness					
Honesty					
Seek Feedback					
Self Compassion					
Mindfulness					
Self Reflection					

SELF COMPASSION

Being kind to ourselves isn't always our first instinct but it's one of the most powerful habits we can build.

What's something you like about yourself?

What's something you feel you're good at?

What's a quality you like about how you treat other people?

SELF COMPASSION

What's something you've worked hard to get good at?

What's a skill or habit that comes easily to you?

What do your friends, family, or teachers often notice you're good at?

What's something you're proud of, even if it's something small or that others might not see?

When you make a mistake, what do you usually say to yourself?

Would you say that to a friend? What's something you could say to yourself instead?

SEEKING FEEDBACK

When you're asking someone for feedback, you can help them by being specific. Try questions like:
"What's one thing I did really well?"
"What's one thing I could improve next time?"
"If you were in my shoes, what would you have done differently?"
"Do you have any advice for me on how to improve?"

Use this space to consider what area you would like feedback on and who you could ask for feedback.

GIVING FEEDBACK

Giving feedback to someone else is just as important as receiving it and it's a skill you can practise! Good feedback helps someone grow and feel supported, rather than criticised. One easy way to do this is using the Grow & Glow method:
🌟 Glow: start with something positive the person did really well.
🌱 Grow: suggest one thing they could improve or work on next time.

When appropriate, use this space to plan what feedback you will give, using the Glow and Grow method.

CREATE YOUR OWN SELF-REFLECTION SYSTEM

One way to grow your self-awareness is through self-reflection - tracking your thoughts, feelings, and actions regularly.

Step 1: Choose what you want to measure? Write down 3 areas.
Examples: *How often did I encourage myself? How energised did I feel? How often did I get enough sleep?*

Step 2: Choose your scoring scale

Numbers: A scale from 1 to 10 (1 = not great, 10 = amazing).

Words: Descriptions like "Rarely, Sometimes, Often, Always."

Symbols: 🌟⭐🌑 or emojis that match how you feel.

Step 3: Practice self-reflection

Practice scoring yourself at the end of each week, using the scale you've selected on your 3 identified areas.

	Weekly self reflection examples	Rating
1.	*Example: How often did I get enough sleep*	*Sometimes*
2.	*Example: How energised did I feel?*	😐
3.	*Example: How often did I encourage myself ?*	*6/10*

Practice	Rating
Area 1:	
Area 2:	
Area 3:	

SELF-REFLECTION JOURNAL

Consistency is key to becoming the best version of yourself. Over the next four weeks, use this page to focus on specific areas of your life and rate how you feel you're doing in each. Remember, growth takes time—be honest and kind with yourself as you reflect!

Week One	Rating
Area 1:	
Area 2:	
Area 3:	

Week Two	Rating
Area 1:	
Area 2:	
Area 3:	

Week Three	Rating
Area 1:	
Area 2:	
Area 3:	

Week Four	Rating
Area 1:	
Area 2:	
Area 3:	

10+ MINI MINDFULNESS EXERCISES

Mindfulness practices enhance self-management by improving emotional regulation, focus, and stress reduction. Activities like the below can help you stay present, manage emotions, and make better decisions

TRACING

Trace your hand with your finger slowly, breathing in as you trace up and out as you trace down.

BALANCE EXERCISE

Stand on one leg for 20 seconds, then switch legs. Focus on staying steady.

MINDFUL EATING

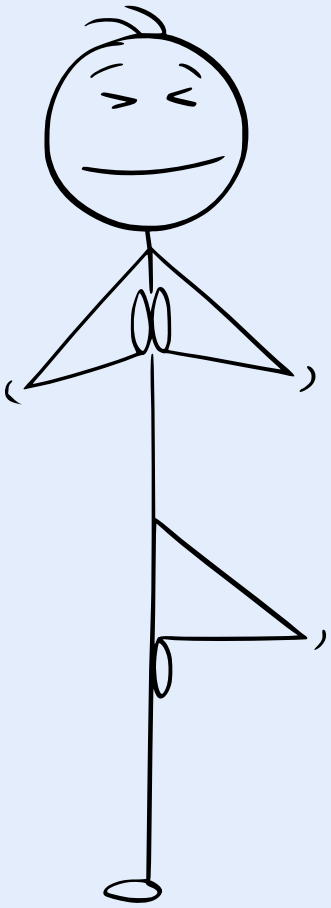
Eat a small piece of food slowly, focusing on taste and texture.

COLOUR EXPLORATION

Look around and find three things of a specific colour

POSTURE CHECK

Sit up straight, relax your shoulders, and take three deep breaths.



DEEP BREATHING

Inhale for 4 seconds, hold for 4 seconds, exhale for 6 seconds. Repeat 3 times.

MINDFUL SMILING

Smile for at least 10 seconds and notice how it makes you feel.

OBSERVATION

Spend one minute noticing your surroundings. What do you see, hear, and feel.

LISTENING

Close your eyes and focus on all the sounds you can hear for one minute.

POSITIVE AFFIRMATION

Say, "I am calm and at peace." Repeat 5 times.

SELF-MANAGEMENT

Self-management is about controlling emotions and staying on track with your goals.

SELF-MANAGEMENT SKILLS RATING	1 (low)	2	3	4	5 (high)
Goal Setting					
Self Motivation					
Time Management					
Personal Development					
Stress Management					
Adaptability					

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

Discovering Your Passions

What activities make you lose track of time because you enjoy them so much?

If you could wake up tomorrow with a new skill or talent, what would you want it to be and why?

Think about the last time you felt really proud of yourself—what were you doing?

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

Understanding Your Purpose

What are some things in the world that you deeply care about?

If you had unlimited time and resources, what problem would you try to solve?

Connecting Passion and Purpose

When you think about your future, what excites you the most?

What is something you do that makes other people happy or benefits them?

What does success mean to you—how do you define a meaningful life?

SIGNS I'M FEELING STRESSED

Stress can show up in our minds, bodies, and behaviours in ways we might not always notice. When you're feeling stressed, you might experience physical signs like headaches, muscle tension, or an upset stomach. Mentally, you could feel overwhelmed, forgetful, or easily irritated. Behaviourally, you might notice changes like difficulty sleeping, withdrawing from others, or losing interest in activities you usually enjoy.

Take a moment to reflect: What signs show up for you when you're feeling stressed? Recognising these signs is the first step to managing stress effectively.

MY STRESS MANAGEMENT TOOLBOX

Your self-management toolbox is a collection of strategies to help you stay calm and in control. Tools like deep breathing, journaling, mindfulness, or taking a walk can make a big difference when life feels overwhelming. What strategies help you manage stress and keep calm? Add them to your toolbox!

GOAL SETTING TEMPLATE EXAMPLES

Below are three different templates for goal setting.

1. SMART Goal Template
Goal: *Your specific goal*
Specific: *What exactly do you want to achieve?*
Measurable: *How will you measure your progress?*
Achievable: *Is this goal realistic and attainable?*
Relevant: *Why is this goal important to you?*
Time-bound: *What is your target date for achieving this goal?*

2. Goal Breakdown Template
Goal: *Your specific goal*
Steps to Achieve This Goal:
Step 1
Step 2
Step 3
Challenges: *What obstacles might you face?*
Motivation: *Why is this goal important?*
Deadline: *When do you want to achieve this?*

3. Action Plan Template
Goal: *Your specific goal*
Why this goal matters: *Explain the significance of the goal for your growth or life*
Actions to Take:
Action 1
Action 2
Action 3
Resources Needed: *List any resources or support you'll need*
Review Date: *Set a date to review your progress*

MY GOALS

Choosing your favourite template, create 3 goals about the kind of person or leader you want to be.

Goal 1

Goal 2

Goal 3

SOCIAL AWARENESS

Social awareness involves understanding others' feelings and perspectives.

SOCIAL AWARENESS SKILLS RATING	1 (low)	2	3	4	5 (high)
Emotional Regulation					
Stress Management					
Active Listening					
Empathy					
Perspective					
Observation					

REFLECTION PROMPTS

Your teammate didn't get invited to a party. How do you show empathy?

A friend is struggling with a tough decision and feels overwhelmed. How do you show empathy?

A classmate didn't perform well on a test and is feeling discouraged. How can you show empathy?

EMPATHY

Here's a list of empathetic responses that can help convey understanding and support during conversations.

Acknowledging Feelings

"That sounds really tough."
"I can see why you'd feel that way."
"I imagine that must have been overwhelming for you."
"I hear you, and it sounds like this has been really challenging."

Showing Understanding

"I understand why this is so important to you."
"That makes a lot of sense to me."
"It sounds like you've been through a lot."
"I get why that would be frustrating/disappointing/exciting."

Encouraging Sharing

"Can you tell me more about what's going on?"
"How can I best support you right now?"
"What do you feel you need most at this moment?"
"I'm here to listen if you want to talk about it."

Expressing Care

"I'm sorry you're going through this."
"I'm here for you. It's okay to feel this way."
"That sounds difficult, I want you to know you're not alone."
"You're doing the best you can, and that's enough."

Validating Their Experience

"It's completely understandable to feel that way."
"You're right; that's not easy to deal with."
"I think anyone would feel the same in your situation."

Reassuring Without Dismissing

"I can't imagine exactly how you're feeling, but I'm here to try to understand."
"You're not alone, I'm here to support you however I can."
"It's okay to take your time to process everything."
"You've got this, even though it's hard right now."
"I believe in your ability to work through this."

RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT

Effective relationships are built on communication, empathy, and trust.

RELATIONSHIP MANAGEMENT SKILLS RATING	1 (low)	2	3	4	5 (high)
Communication					
Healthy Relationships					
Active Listening					
Appreciation					
Conflict Resolution					
Connection					

REFLECTION PROMPTS

Write about a time when clear communication helped resolve a conflict. What happened?

What did you learn?

APPRECIATION AND GRATITUDE

Who is someone in your life that you're grateful for? What have they done to make a positive impact on you?

Think about a challenge you've faced recently. What's one lesson you learned from it that you appreciate?

What's a small, everyday thing that you often overlook but are grateful for when you really think about it?

Think about a place that makes you feel safe or happy. Why is it special to you?

What's something your family (or chosen family) does that makes you feel loved or supported?

What's something about yourself—your personality, strengths, or values—that you appreciate?

VALUES, CHARACTER TRAITS, & STRENGTHS

Values

Values are the principles and beliefs that guide your choices and actions. They're about what's important to you in life - like kindness, honesty, or freedom.

Character Traits

Character traits describe your personality, the qualities that make you, you. They show how you usually behave and interact with people - like being patient, friendly, or determined.

Strengths

Strengths are your skills and abilities, the things you're good at. They might be natural talents or things you've practiced, like solving problems, listening, or staying calm.

Values = What matters most to you
Character Traits = Who you are
Strengths = What you're good at

REFLECTION

How can you live more fully by your values this week?

Which of your character traits makes you proudest, and why?

Which strength would you like to use more often?

VALUES, CHARACTER TRAITS, & STRENGTHS

From each list below, circle 3 words that feel most true or meaningful to you

VALUES	TRAITS	STRENGTHS
Kindness	Friendly	Listening
Honesty	Calm	Problem-solving
Fairness	Trustworthy	Organising
Respect	Curious	Teamwork
Compassion	Optimistic	Leading
Adventure	Funny	Helping others
Freedom	Caring	Speaking up
Justice	Generous	Making friends
Loyalty	Patient	Thinking of new ideas
Love	Honest	Staying calm
Learning	Open-minded	Staying positive
Gratitude	Determined	Writing
Creativity	Brave	Drawing
Courage	Empathetic	Building things
Family	Polite	Planning ahead
Friendship	Respectful	Encouraging others
Growth	Responsible	Understanding feelings
Peace	Adventurous	Learning quickly
Success	Dependable	Sticking with hard things
Helping others	Thoughtful	Explaining things clearly
Happiness	Creative	Staying focused
Faith	Humble	Noticing details
Integrity	Confident	Solving conflict
Responsibility	Resilient	Taking initiative

Now choose one of your highlighted words from each list to fill in the below sentence

I value _____ ,

I am a _____ person,

and one of my strengths is

_____ .

LEADERSHIP REFLECTIONS

Leadership is a journey, not a destination. As you reflect on your own leadership, it's important to identify the qualities that resonate with you, as well as areas where you'd like to grow. This section encourages you to think deeply about the type of leader you aspire to be, the qualities you admire in others, and the skills you are actively developing.

Think about a leader you look up to - whether in your personal life, in sports, or in history. **List the person in the middle below and 4 x qualities that stand out to you.**

MY INSPIRATIONAL LEADER

Take a moment to reflect on the strengths YOU already possess as a leader.
What leadership skills or qualities do you have?

CURRENT SKILLS AND STRENGTHS

SKILLS OTHERS NOTICE

No leader is ever truly "finished" in their development. Be specific below about skills that could improve both your leadership and personal growth.
What leadership skills or qualities would you like to develop?

MY LEADERSHIP VISION

Consider what leadership means to you personally and the impact you want to have on those you lead.

As a leader, I want to be someone who...

FINAL REFLECTIONS

Which value, character trait, or strength stood out to you the most during this journey, and why?

What's one thing you've learned about yourself from completing this journal?

How do you want to use your strengths to help yourself or others in the future?

Which area - self-awareness, self-management, social awareness, or relationship management - do you most want to keep improving, and what's one step you can take?

Who or what inspires you to keep becoming the best version of yourself?

If you could set one meaningful goal for the next month, based on what you discovered here, what would it be?

GLOSSARY

A

Adaptability – Being able to change and adjust when things don't go as planned.
Affirmation – A positive statement you say to yourself to help build confidence and self-belief.
Appreciation – Recognising and being grateful for the good things in life, including people, experiences, and achievements.

C

Character Strengths – The personal qualities and traits that make you who you are, like kindness, honesty, or bravery.
Compassion – Showing kindness and understanding towards others, especially when they are struggling.
Conflict Resolution – Finding a peaceful and fair way to solve disagreements.

E

Emotional Intelligence – The ability to understand and manage your own emotions while also recognising and responding to the emotions of others.
Empathy – Understanding how someone else is feeling and showing that you care.
Ethics – A set of principles about what is right and wrong that guide decisions and behaviour.

G

Goal Setting – The process of deciding what you want to achieve and making a plan to reach it.
Gratitude – Being thankful and recognising the good things in your life.

I

Integrity – Being honest and sticking to your values, even when it's difficult.
Introspection – Thinking deeply about your own thoughts, feelings, and experiences.

L

Leadership – The ability to guide, inspire, and support others in a positive way.
Lived Experience – Personal knowledge gained through real-life experiences, rather than from books or lessons.

GLOSSARY

M

Mindfulness – Paying full attention to the present moment, including your thoughts, feelings, and surroundings, without judgment.

Motivation – The drive or reason behind why you do something.

P

Perspective – The way you see and understand a situation, which might be different from how someone else sees it.

Personal Development – The process of improving your skills, knowledge, and understanding of yourself to become a better person.

R

Reflection – Thinking about your experiences, actions, and feelings to understand them better and learn from them.

Resilience – The ability to recover from challenges, setbacks, or tough times without giving up.

Respect – Treating yourself and others with kindness, fairness, and consideration.

S

Self-Awareness – Understanding your own emotions, thoughts, and behaviours, and how they affect yourself and others.

Self-Compassion – Being kind to yourself, especially when you make mistakes or are having a tough time.

Self-Management – Controlling your emotions, behaviours, and actions to stay focused on your goals.

Social Awareness – Understanding how other people feel and what's happening in the world around you.

SMART Goals – A way to set goals that are Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.

Stress Management – Techniques to help you stay calm and in control when feeling overwhelmed.

V

Values – The beliefs and principles that are most important to you and help guide your decisions and actions.

REFERENCES

Emotional Intelligence
Resource: "Improving Emotional Intelligence (EQ): Expert Guide" by HelpGuide.org
Summary: This guide discusses the four key skills to enhance emotional intelligence, including self-management and relationship management.
helpguide.org

Self-Awareness and Self-Management
Resource: "SEL for Students: Self-Awareness and Self-Management" by Greater Good in Education
Summary: This article explores the importance of self-awareness and self-management in students, providing strategies to manage emotions and behaviours effectively.
ggie.berkeley.edu

Social Awareness and Relationship Skills
Resource: "The 5 Social Emotional Learning (SEL) Core Competencies" by Positive Action
Summary: This resource outlines the five core competencies of SEL, including social awareness and relationship skills, essential for positive interactions and empathy development.
positiveaction.net

Leadership and Emotional Intelligence
Resource: "Emotional Intelligence in Leadership: Why It's Important" by Harvard Business School Online
Summary: This article emphasizes the role of emotional intelligence in effective leadership, highlighting skills such as coaching teams, managing stress, and delivering feedback.
online.hbs.edu

Character Strengths and Values
Resource: "Positive Psychology" article on Wikipedia
Summary: This entry provides an overview of positive psychology, discussing the importance of character strengths and values in achieving well-being and personal growth.
en.wikipedia.org

Stress Management and Resilience
Resource :"7 Mental Health Practices To Cultivate Resilience in 2025" by Health.com
Summary: This article offers practical strategies for building resilience and managing stress, such as developing a growth mindset and practicing mindfulness.
health.com

Goal Setting and Mindfulness
Resource: "Emotional Intelligence Skills: 5 Components of EQ" by Verywell Mind
Summary: This article discusses components of emotional intelligence, including self-regulation and motivation, which are crucial for effective goal setting and practicing mindfulness.
verywellmind.com

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